

NovaStore

Customer Support Knowledge Base

Internal reference manual for customer service operations

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Purpose: This fictional document is designed as the source corpus for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) customer-support agent. The agent should answer policy questions only when the information is supported by this knowledge base.

Training / portfolio document - no real customer data

1. Company and Support Scope

NovaStore is a fictional online retailer of consumer electronics and accessories. The Customer Support team assists customers with orders, shipping, returns, refunds, warranties, payments, cancellations, and general product-policy questions.

Support agents must distinguish between policy questions and account-specific requests. Policy questions may be answered from this knowledge base. Account-specific information, such as the live status of a specific order, must be retrieved from an authorized operational system or API.

RAG rule: If the knowledge base does not contain enough information to support an answer, the assistant must say that it does not have sufficient information and should not invent a policy.

2. Returns and Exchanges

2.1 Standard return window

Most eligible products may be returned within **30 calendar days from the delivery date**. The product must be in good condition and include its original accessories, manuals, and packaging when reasonably possible.

2.2 Conditions

- A proof of purchase or valid NovaStore order number is required.
- Products showing accidental damage, unauthorized modification, or misuse are not eligible for a standard return.
- A return request submitted within the 30-day window remains valid while NovaStore provides the return instructions.
- Customers should not ship a return before receiving the return authorization instructions.

2.3 Non-returnable items

- Digital gift cards and downloadable digital products after delivery or activation.
- Personalized or custom-configured products, except when defective.
- Items explicitly marked Final Sale at the time of purchase.
- Opened hygiene-sensitive accessories, including in-ear tips, when the protective seal has been broken.

2.4 Exchanges

Direct exchanges are available only when the requested replacement is the same product model in a different color or an identical replacement for an eligible defective unit. Other changes are processed as a return followed by a new purchase.

3. Refunds

3.1 Refund processing

After a returned product reaches the NovaStore returns facility, inspection normally takes **2 to 4 business days**. Once approved, the refund is issued to the original payment method.

After NovaStore issues a refund, banks and card providers may require an additional **3 to 10 business days** to display the credit. NovaStore cannot accelerate a bank's posting time.

3.2 Shipping charges

Original standard shipping charges are refundable only when the return results from a NovaStore fulfillment error or a confirmed defective product. Expedited shipping upgrades are not refundable unless NovaStore failed to provide the purchased expedited service.

4. Shipping and Delivery

4.1 Order processing

Orders for in-stock products are normally prepared within **1 to 2 business days**. Orders placed after 16:00 local warehouse time may begin processing on the next business day.

4.2 Estimated delivery times

Shipping method	Estimated transit time
Standard	3-6 business days after dispatch
Express	1-3 business days after dispatch
Same-day (eligible zones)	By 22:00 on the purchase date

Delivery estimates are not guarantees. Severe weather, carrier disruptions, incorrect addresses, security checks, or exceptional demand may cause delays.

4.3 Tracking

A tracking link is sent when the carrier accepts the shipment. Tracking events may take up to 24 hours to appear after dispatch.

Tool-use rule: The knowledge base does not contain the live location or current status of individual orders. Questions such as “Where is order NS-10452?” require the order-status tool/API.

5. Lost, Delayed, and Damaged Shipments

5.1 Delayed shipment

If a shipment has not arrived by the end of the estimated delivery window, the customer should allow **2 additional business days** for carrier delays before a lost-shipment investigation is opened.

5.2 Marked delivered but not received

Customers should first check household members, reception areas, safe-drop locations, and nearby entrances. If the package remains missing after 24 hours from the carrier's delivered scan, NovaStore Support may open a carrier investigation.

5.3 Shipping damage

Visible shipping damage should be reported within **72 hours of delivery**. Customers should retain the packaging and provide photographs of the external package, shipping label, damaged item, and internal protective material when requested.

6. Warranty Policy

6.1 Standard limited warranty

NovaStore-branded hardware includes a **12-month limited warranty from the original delivery date**. Third-party products follow the manufacturer's warranty unless the product page explicitly states a NovaStore warranty.

6.2 Covered defects

- Manufacturing defects in materials or workmanship under normal intended use.
- Hardware failure not caused by accidental damage, liquid exposure, misuse, or unauthorized modification.

6.3 Not covered

- Cosmetic wear that does not affect normal operation.

- Accidental damage, drops, crushing, liquid damage, misuse, or improper storage.
- Damage caused by unauthorized repair, modification, or incompatible third-party components.

7. Payments

7.1 Accepted methods

NovaStore accepts major credit and debit cards and other payment methods displayed during checkout. Availability may vary by country and transaction.

7.2 Payment authorization

An order may remain pending while the payment provider completes authorization or fraud-prevention checks. A pending authorization is not the same as a completed charge.

7.3 Failed payments

NovaStore Support cannot override a bank decline. Customers should verify billing details, available funds, card restrictions, or contact their payment provider. Support may confirm whether NovaStore received a successful payment authorization.

8. Order Changes and Cancellations

8.1 Cancellation

Customers may request cancellation while an order is still in **Pending** or **Processing** status. Cancellation is not guaranteed once warehouse fulfillment has begun.

Orders already marked **Shipped** cannot be cancelled. The customer may use the standard return process after delivery if the item is eligible.

8.2 Address changes

A shipping address may be corrected only before the order enters warehouse fulfillment. For security reasons, NovaStore cannot redirect an order to a different country after purchase.

9. Customer Support and Escalation

9.1 Standard support

NovaStore customer support is available Monday through Friday, 09:00-18:00 local support time, excluding public holidays. Automated support may operate outside these hours.

9.2 Escalation triggers

- Repeated delivery failure after a carrier investigation.
- Suspected payment fraud or account takeover.
- Safety-related product complaint.
- A customer disputes a policy after the relevant policy has been clearly explained.
- The knowledge base does not contain sufficient information for a high-impact decision.

9.3 Agent behavior

Support responses should be concise, respectful, and grounded in available information. The assistant should explain the relevant policy and, when useful, identify the next action the customer can take.

Do not hallucinate: The assistant must not fabricate order status, refunds, warranty approvals, inventory, prices, account details, or policies that are not present in an authorized data source.

10. Example Support Questions

- “My headphones arrived 12 days ago. Can I return them?” - Use the 30-day return policy and applicable eligibility conditions.

- “How long does a refund take?” - Explain the 2-4 business day inspection period plus the payment provider's 3-10 business day posting period.
- “My order says delivered but I cannot find it.” - Explain the 24-hour waiting/check procedure before a carrier investigation.
- “Can I cancel an order that already shipped?” - No. Explain that shipped orders cannot be cancelled and may be returned after delivery if eligible.
- “Where is order NS-10452 right now?” - Do not answer from the knowledge base; invoke the authorized order-status tool/API.

11. Retrieval Metadata Recommendations

For portfolio implementation, chunks should retain metadata that can be surfaced as citations or debugging context. Recommended metadata fields include: **document_name**, **section**, **policy_category**, **version**, and **source_type**.

Suggested policy categories: returns, refunds, shipping, delivery_issues, warranty, payments, cancellations, and support.

The retrieval system should favor semantically relevant chunks while applying a minimum relevance threshold. If retrieved evidence is weak or unrelated, the agent should use the documented fallback rather than generating an unsupported answer.